

Create an Industry Deep Dive for How do private equity firms, infrastructure funds, and family offices active in maritime, transport, and logistics sectors typically source their advisors and consultants? What are the most common advisor selection criteria, preferred firm types (large vs boutique, generalist vs sector-specialist), and the typical scope of advisory engagements at different deal stages (pre-deal, transaction, post-close, exit preparation)?

Industry Deep Dive: Private Equity & Infrastructure Fund Advisory Selection in Maritime, Transport & Logistics

Executive Summary

- **Boutique sector specialists are securing strategic partnerships with major logistics operators:** Fisher Management Partners partnered with LSPedia for pharmaceutical supply chain compliance, completing deployments in four months, while specialized firms like Cyrias executed dozens of Ivalua procurement implementations ^[1]
- **Advisory scope extends beyond transaction support into operational transformation:** Partnerships increasingly focus on end-to-end execution — from compliance and deployment to change management and post-close optimization — rather than traditional due diligence ^[1]
- **Major infrastructure funds dominate maritime and logistics investments:** KKR, Blackstone, Stonepeak Infrastructure Partners, Ardian, and Global Infrastructure Partners collectively manage portfolios spanning transport infrastructure, cold chain logistics, and maritime assets ^[6]
- **Engineering and technical consultancies capture specialized work:** Unique Maritime Group executed subsea engineering for DEEP's underwater habitat project and partnered with University of Glasgow on marine technology trials, indicating demand for deep domain expertise in maritime infrastructure ^[1]
- **Technology integration drives consultant selection:** GXO's partnerships with McLaren Racing and Hunkemoller demonstrate how logistics operators prioritize advisors who can deliver both operational excellence and technology-enabled solutions ^[1]

Current Market Traction

Major Incumbents

The private equity and infrastructure fund landscape in maritime, transport, and logistics is anchored by established firms with significant assets under management:

Firm	Focus Areas	Notable Activity
Blackstone	Alternative assets including infrastructure and logistics real estate	Acquired Global Infrastructure Partners for \$12.5B in January 2024
KKR	Private equity, credit, and real assets across transport sectors	Active in logistics and infrastructure investments globally [2]
Stonepeak Infrastructure Partners	Transport, energy, digital infrastructure	Mosaic score of 464/1000; manages investments in logistics and maritime assets [6]
Ardian	Infrastructure, transport, and energy sectors	Mosaic score of 560/1000; received \$700M debt financing from Bain Capital in 2021 [5]
Global Infrastructure Partners	Energy, transport, digital infrastructure	Managed ~\$103B in assets before \$12.5B acquisition by BlackRock [7]

Notable Partnerships

Advisory and consulting partnerships reveal how funds and portfolio companies actually engage external expertise:

Supply Chain & Logistics Consulting

- March 2026: LSPedia and Fisher Management Partners formed alliance targeting pharmaceutical manufacturers and 3PLs navigating Drug Supply Chain Security Act compliance, offering operational maturity assessments, SOP development, and multi-site deployment program management [\[1\]](#)
- October 2025: Softeon partnered with Tryon Solutions (530+ engagements, 100% go-live track record) to deliver warehouse management system implementations and test automation for food and beverage, pharmaceuticals, and high-volume 3PL operations [\[1\]](#)

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July 2025: Cleo and Effective Data expanded their 20+ year partnership to deliver B2B/EDI integration, managed file transfer, and API connectivity for logistics, transportation, manufacturing, and retail sectors [\[1\]](#)

Maritime & Infrastructure Engineering

- February 2026: Unique Maritime Group partnered with Rovtech to distribute VALOR ROV systems across Middle East and Asia Pacific, including Q1 2026 training program for regional service centers [\[1\]](#)
- January 2026: Unique Maritime Group collaborated with University of Glasgow and Scottish Association for Marine Science on marine restoration technology trials using unmanned survey vessels at Loch Melfort, Scotland [\[1\]](#)
- November 2025: Unique Maritime Group provided engineering services for DEEP's Vanguard underwater habitat project, including foundation design and life-support systems [\[1\]](#)

Technology & Operations Integration

- April 2026: GXO Logistics became Official Partner of Arrow McLaren IndyCar Team for Indianapolis 500, positioning around operational excellence messaging [\[1\]](#)
- January 2026: GXO began managing Hunkemoller's B2B logistics operations from 32,000-square-meter facility in Almere, integrating B2B and e-commerce fulfillment with shuttle systems and shelf-to-person robotic picking [\[1\]](#)
- September 2025: GlobalLogic and Flexware Innovation (both Hitachi companies) deployed LIFT 3.0 intralogistics software at Hitachi Rail's \$100M Maryland facility, orchestrating PLCs, SCADA, ERP, MES, and WMS systems [\[1\]](#)

Active Investors

Private equity and infrastructure funds most active in maritime, transport, and logistics advisory relationships:

Infrastructure-Focused Funds

- [Stonepeak Infrastructure Partners](#): Focuses on transport, logistics, and digital infrastructure; raised \$100M from Landmark Partners in 2018 [\[6\]](#)
- [Global Infrastructure Partners](#): Specialized in energy, transport, and water infrastructure before BlackRock acquisition [\[7\]](#)
- [Ardian Infrastructure](#): Operates across transport, energy, renewables, and digital infrastructure with sustainability focus [\[8\]](#)

- **IFM Investors**: Institutional investment firm with infrastructure, private equity focus; Mosaic score of 489/1000 [9]
- **Macquarie Asset Management**: Offers real assets, real estate, and infrastructure investment solutions [10]

Diversified Private Equity Firms

- **Blackstone**: Largest alternative asset manager with significant logistics real estate and transport holdings [3]
- **KKR**: Active across private equity, credit, and real assets in transportation sectors [2]
- **Apollo Global Management**: Private equity and credit focused on industrial and transport investments [11]
- **Carlyle**: Investment firm with \$1.4B funding from Mubadala Development Company in 2007 [4]
- **EQT**: Global investment organization with infrastructure and industrial technology focus [12]
- **Brookfield**: Manages infrastructure, renewable power, private equity, real estate, and credit globally [13]

Sovereign and Institutional Capital

- **GIC**: Singapore sovereign wealth fund with Mosaic score of 645/1000; active in private equity and infrastructure [14]
- **Starwood Capital Group**: Real estate-focused private investment firm with maritime and transport infrastructure exposure [15]

Emerging Trends

Sector-Specialist Boutiques Capture Complex Compliance Work

Boutique consultancies with deep domain expertise are securing engagements that larger generalist firms cannot efficiently execute. Fisher Management Partners' alliance with LSPedia specifically targets DSCSA compliance, serialized data exchange, and exception management — operational challenges requiring both regulatory knowledge and technical implementation capability [1]. Similarly, Tryon Solutions' 530+ WMS implementations with 100% go-live success rate position it as a specialist for high-stakes supply chain technology deployments [1].

Engineering Consultancies Expand Beyond Transaction Advisory

Maritime and logistics infrastructure projects increasingly require consultants who can execute rather than simply advise. Unique Maritime Group's partnerships demonstrate this shift: the firm provided foundation design and life-support engineering for DEEP's subsea habitat, distributed ROV systems across Middle East and Asia Pacific markets, and conducted marine restoration technology trials with academic institutions ^[1]. This operational scope extends far beyond traditional due diligence or transaction support.

Technology Integration Becomes Core Selection Criterion

Logistics operators prioritize consultants who can deliver both strategic guidance and technical execution. GlobalLogic and Flexware Innovation's deployment of LIFT 3.0 at Hitachi Rail orchestrated communication across PLCs, SCADA, ERP, MES, and WMS systems — solving interoperability challenges that pure strategy consultants cannot address ^[1]. Cleo and Effective Data's 20+ year partnership similarly combines B2B/EDI integration with cloud-based data management and API connectivity ^[1].

Multi-Stage Engagement Models Replace Point-In-Time Advisory

Consulting relationships increasingly span multiple deal stages rather than discrete transactions. LSPedia and Fisher Management Partners' alliance covers program management for multi-site deployments, change management, and ROI modeling — supporting portfolio companies from initial assessment through post-close optimization ^[1]. Softeon and Tryon Solutions' partnership similarly extends from WMS implementation through testing, training, and ongoing digital transformation ^[1].

Future Considerations

Headwinds

Regulatory Complexity Increases Advisory Costs: Maritime decarbonization requirements (IMO and EU frameworks) and pharmaceutical supply chain compliance (DSCSA) create demand for specialized consultants, but also increase engagement costs. Lloyd's Register Group's training programs for Grandi Navi Veloci on energy efficiency and alternative fuels illustrate the ongoing education required as regulations evolve ^[1].

Generalist Consultant Displacement: Large strategy firms face growing competition from sector-specialist boutiques in maritime, transport, and logistics. Fisher Management Partners' pharmaceutical supply chain expertise and Tryon Solutions' WMS implementation track record demonstrate capability advantages that generalists cannot easily replicate ^[1].

Technology Integration Complexity: As logistics operations require orchestration across PLCs, SCADA, ERP, MES, and WMS systems, consultants must possess both strategic and technical capabilities. This raises barriers to entry but also increases implementation risk ^[1].

Tailwinds

Infrastructure Investment Surge Creates Advisory Demand: \$1.2T+ in US manufacturing investment announced in 2025 positions infrastructure funds to deploy capital into transport, logistics, and maritime assets, driving demand for transaction advisory and post-close operational support ^[16].

Private Equity Dry Powder: Established funds including KKR, Blackstone, Carlyle, and Stonepeak maintain significant capital available for deployment in logistics and transport infrastructure, sustaining consultant demand across deal cycles .

Operational Value Creation Focus: As financial engineering opportunities compress, PE funds increasingly prioritize operational improvements in portfolio companies. Partnerships like GXO-Hunkemoller (32,000 sq m facility with advanced automation) and GlobalLogic-Flexware (LIFT 3.0 deployment) demonstrate consultant value in post-acquisition optimization ^[1].

Maritime Decarbonization Requirements: Regulatory pressure to adopt alternative fuels, optimize energy efficiency, and reduce emissions creates sustained demand for specialized engineering and technical consultants. Lloyd's Register Group's ongoing training programs with ferry operators and Hiringa Energy's hydrogen refuelling infrastructure partnerships illustrate this structural tailwind ^[1].

Sources

1. [Relationship Search Results](#)
2. [KKR](#)
3. [Blackstone](#)
4. [Carlyle](#)
5. [Ardian](#)
6. [Stonepeak Infrastructure Partners](#)
7. [Global Infrastructure Partners](#)
8. [Ardian Infrastructure](#)
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13. [Brookfield](#)

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15. [Starwood Capital Group](#)

16. [The manufacturing robotics market map: 115+ companies building the automated factory of the future](#)